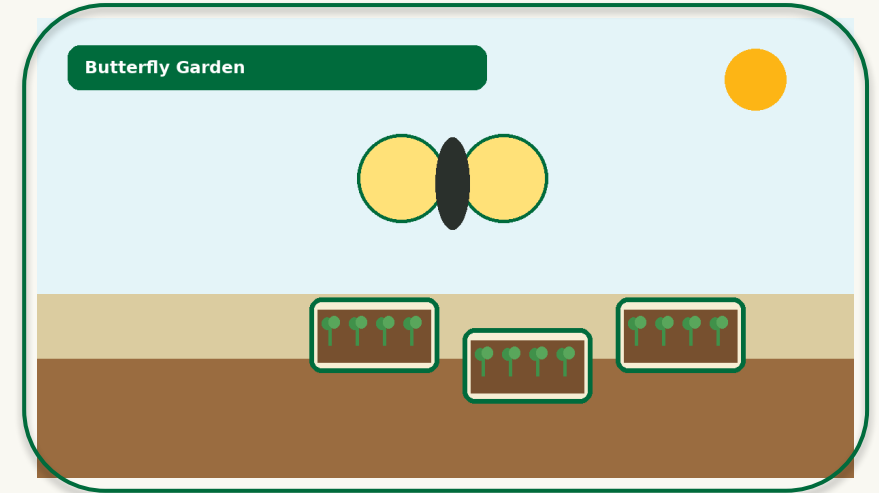


Butterfly Garden

Introducing Pollinators and Plants

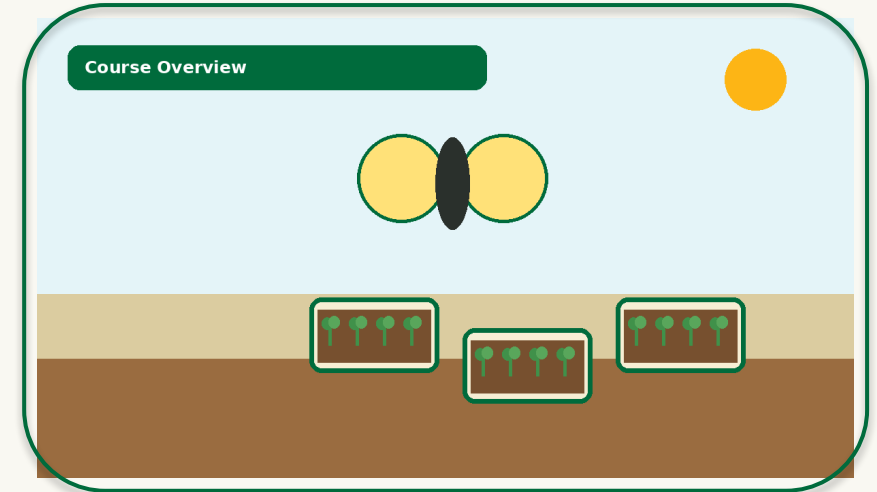
- LIFEWS AgriShine™ GrowMeal™ Nursery Teacher Training
- Audience: Nursery teachers, teaching assistants and garden facilitators
- Format: Self-paced online course + supervised practical orientation
- Recommended duration: 2 hours 30 minutes online + 60 minutes garden practical



Course Overview

Learning outcomes, materials and completion requirements

- By the end of the course, teachers should be able to explain the garden's learning purpose, prepare age-appropriate activities, facilitate the ten course topics, manage children safely outdoors, and document learning through observation.
- Recommended materials: teacher guide; picture/word cards appropriate to the garden; child-safe tools where needed; watering equipment; observation sheets; drawing materials; labels; handwashing supplies; first-aid access.
- Completion: review all modules, complete the practical teacher task, and demonstrate safe supervision of one short garden lesson.



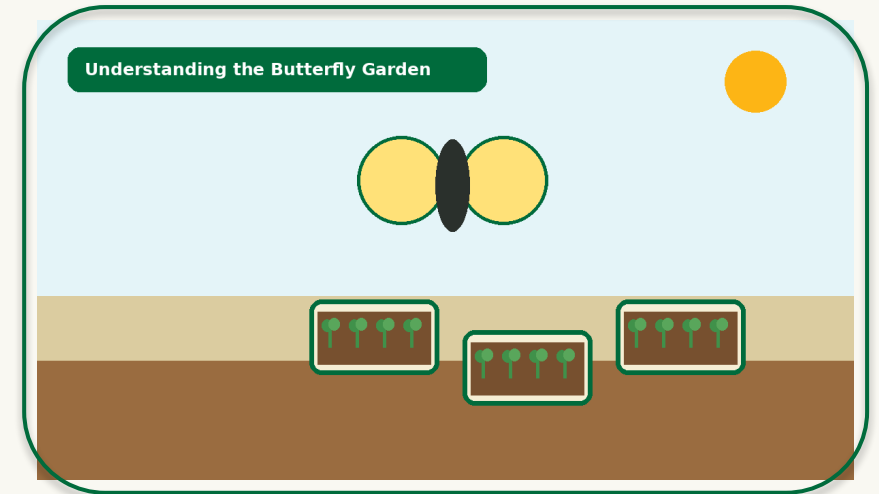
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Training principle: concrete experience first, simple language second, repetition throughout.

Understanding the Butterfly Garden

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- A Butterfly Garden combines flowering plants, food plants and safe habitat features to support observation of garden visitors.
- At Nursery level, focus on noticing relationships: flowers attract visitors; plants provide food and shelter.
- Never promise that butterflies will appear during a lesson.
- Use photographs or cards when live visitors are absent.
- Teacher routine: NOTICE → NAME → WATCH → WONDER → CARE.



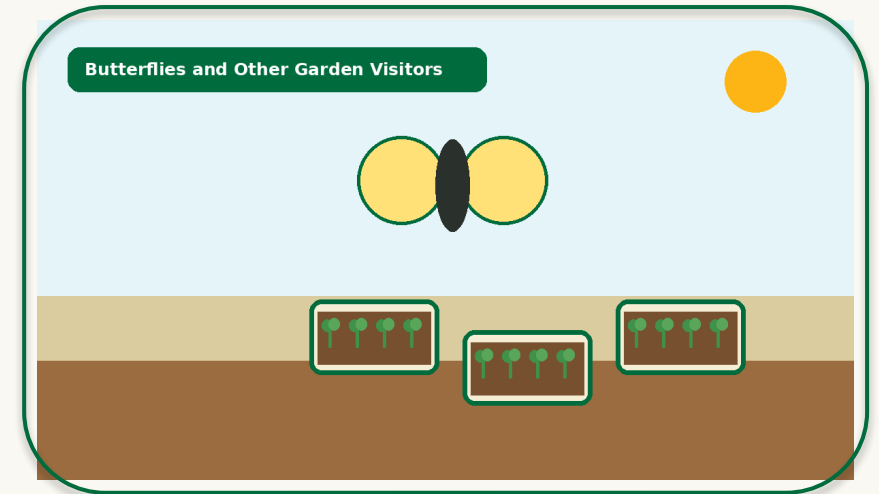
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Identify safe observation points and flowering plants.

Butterflies and Other Garden Visitors

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Introduce butterflies alongside bees, beetles and other visible garden visitors without requiring detailed classification.
- Explain that different small animals visit plants for different reasons.
- Use calm observation rather than catching insects.
- Distinguish “look” from “touch”; most visitors should be watched without handling.
- Build simple vocabulary: butterfly, bee, insect, flower, wing, garden visitor.



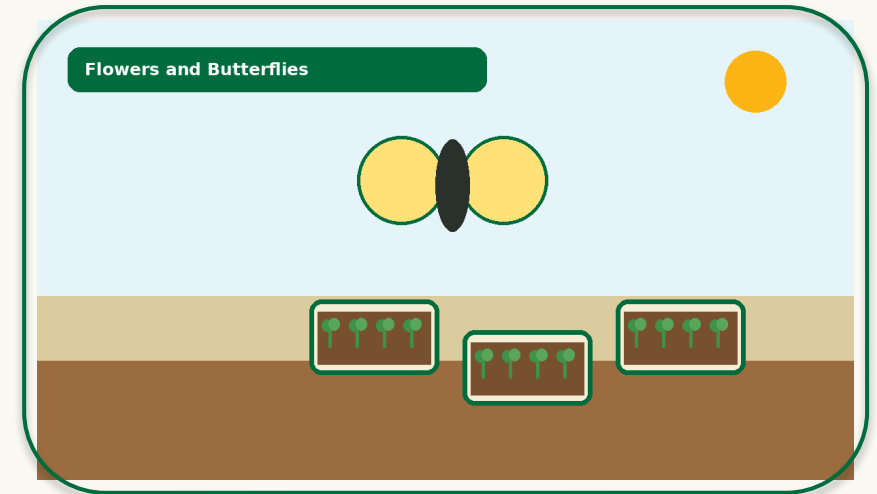
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare clear picture cards for common local visitors.

Flowers and Butterflies

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Show that butterflies often visit flowers for nectar.
- Observe flower color, shape and position while waiting for visitors.
- Use a picture sequence if no butterfly is present.
- Ask children what the butterfly is doing rather than telling them every answer.
- Avoid spraying or disturbing flowers during observation.



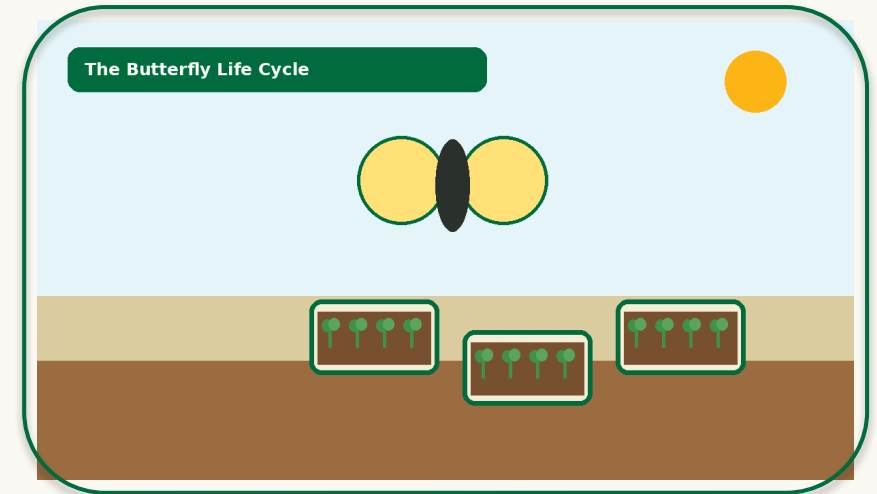
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Choose a flowering area visible from a safe path.

The Butterfly Life Cycle

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Introduce the simple sequence: egg → caterpillar → chrysalis/pupa → butterfly.
- Use large pictures or models because all stages may not be present in the garden.
- Explain that caterpillars need suitable host plants.
- Keep the sequence visual and age-appropriate.
- Do not collect wild eggs or caterpillars unless the school has an approved educational protocol.



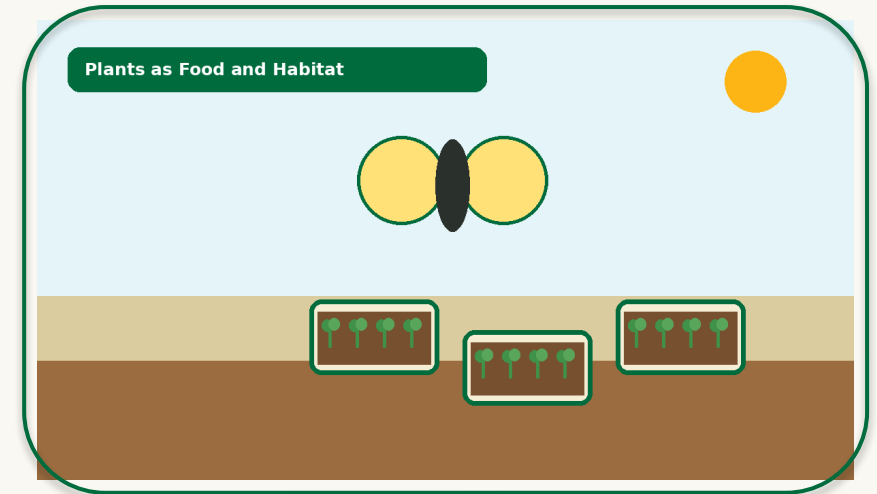
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare four large life-cycle cards.

Plants as Food and Habitat

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Explain that some plants provide nectar for adult butterflies and others provide leaves for caterpillars.
- Dense or varied planting can also provide shelter.
- Connect plant care with caring for garden life.
- Avoid presenting all insects as pests.
- Use locally appropriate, non-invasive plant choices selected by the garden program.



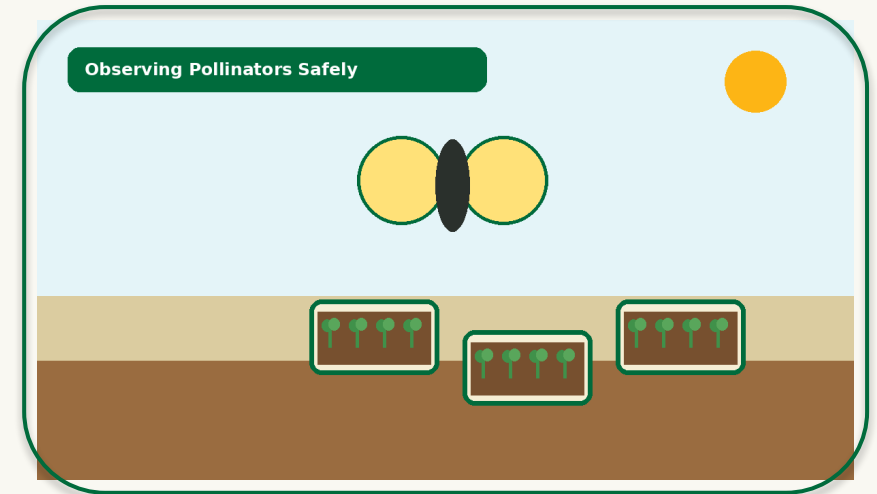
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Identify nectar and host-plant examples used in the garden.

Observing Pollinators Safely

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Stay on paths and watch from a respectful distance.
- Do not swat, chase, trap or handle pollinators.
- Keep food and sweet drinks away from the observation area.
- Teach children to remain calm around bees and follow school procedures if stings occur.
- Avoid observation during unsafe weather or excessive heat.
- Know allergy and emergency procedures before the activity.



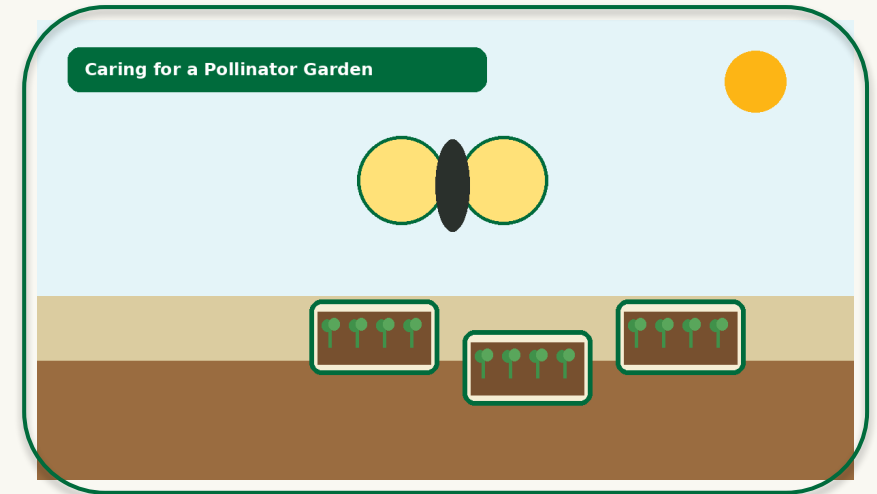
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Practice a quiet 2-minute observation routine.

Caring for a Pollinator Garden

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Water plants appropriately and avoid flooding flowers.
- Remove weeds carefully while preserving intended habitat plants.
- Keep pathways clean without over-sanitizing habitat areas.
- Do not use pesticides during teacher-led activities unless managed under approved professional protocols.
- Replace failed plants with suitable garden-program selections.
- Record flowering periods and visible visitors.



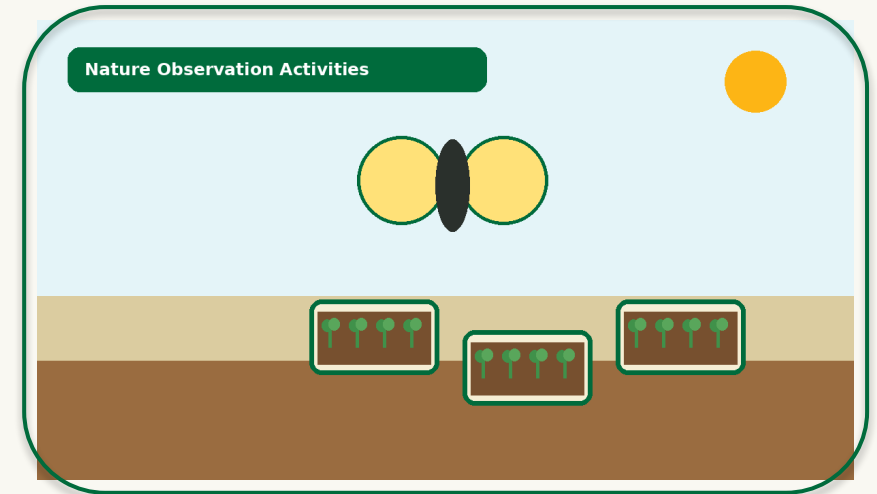
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Assign simple teacher-supervised care tasks.

Nature Observation Activities

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Quiet Watch: count or describe visitors seen in a short period.
- Flower Match: match picture cards to flowering plants.
- Wing Shapes: compare butterfly pictures without handling live insects.
- What Is It Doing?: describe resting, flying or feeding.
- Garden Visitor Journal: teacher records children's words beside drawings.



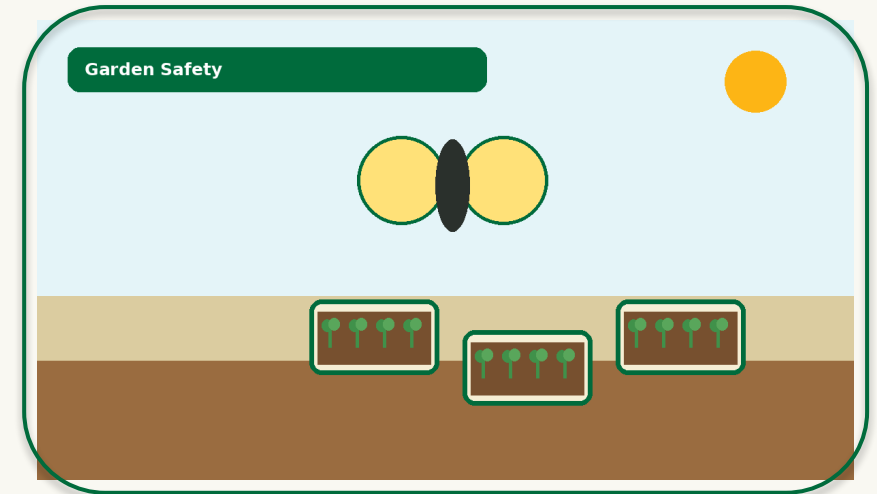
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Choose one activity that works even if no butterflies appear.

Garden Safety

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Inspect paths, flowering areas, water points and structures before pupils enter.
- Know allergy, sting and first-aid procedures.
- Keep children away from nests, hives or aggressive insects.
- Use sun/heat precautions required by the school.
- No tasting of flowers or leaves unless part of an approved food activity.
- Wash hands after gardening.



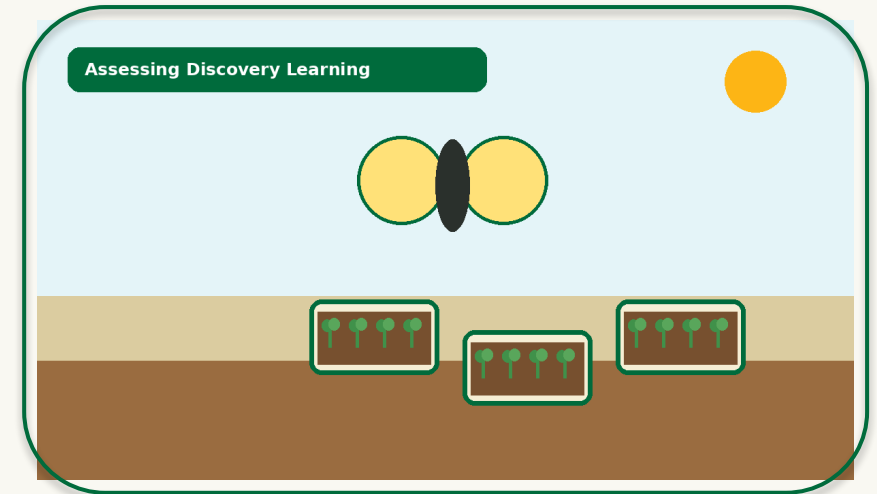
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Pre-lesson safety check: insects • plants • paths • weather • hygiene.

Assessing Discovery Learning

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Observe whether children can name a butterfly or garden visitor, identify a flower, describe one observed behavior and state one way to care for the garden.
- Value noticing and questioning, not memorization alone.
- Use drawings, oral responses and teacher notes.
- Separate what the child actually observed from what was shown in pictures.
- Repeat observations across seasons because visitor activity changes.



TEACHER PRACTICE

- Completion task: plan a 30-minute pollinator discovery session.